

As I fell, its rough claws continued to grab onto me, and the coarse, rocky flecks pierced through my cheeks. I couldn't open my eyes. I was scared the claws would sink through them too, as if there was any hope that I would see anything. As the world got darker, I realized my eyelids were barely staying on my face. My arms flailed around, failing to find something to thrash against, and my hands swiped at nothing. Both were too late to reach the claws. The chill holding onto my spine found its way into the rest of my body before I could realize how cold everything got.

Suddenly, all at once, there was nothing. The claws' hold didn't change. The growing darkness didn't feel any lighter, but everything felt soft and familiar. I was suffocating, yet I couldn't bring myself to fight it. My hands were the first to find themselves at rest. In that moment, the claws held onto my fingertips, taking the sharpness off the ends until the top of my hands were bare. The claws then found the stumps where my hands used to be, and I knew my arms would be next to erode. The claws continued to pick and eat away at my body, and I had no other option than to sleep, so I slept and waited for it to end, as the ocean combed through my hair one more time.